

If you want to go a step further use an email provider like RiseUp. <https://mail.riseup.net> provides free email and is aimed at activists who need a secure and anonymous means of communication. The company uses a secure connection for both logging in and sending emails just like Gmail, and also has very strict policies in place to protect their customer's privacy. But the thing with Riseup is that you need 'two invite codes' from existing users to signup. There are a number of other secure web services like Rmail, Sendinc and Hushmail which provided a free limited account and fully featured paid account.

Infoencrypt is a website that lets you encrypt the text of your email. All you have to do is enter the text and a strong encryption password and it will encrypt the text using a strong encryption algorithm. Copy paste the text into your email, and share the key separately with your recipient.

Instant Messenger

Instant Messengers are the quickest form of communication used in today's world. There are a number of secure instant messaging applications and services out there. The best options if you want to secure your IM conversation are

- WhatsApp, the world's most popular instant messaging service currently owned by Facebook, added end to end encryption to its application a few months ago. What this means is that the messages sent by you are automatically encrypted and decrypted only by the receiver. This makes it almost impossible for anyone snooping on your conversation to intercept and understand the messages. Even the company itself can't decrypt your messages. WhatsApp offers more than enough basic security for the privacy conscious out there but it still lacks in places. The company still keeps a backup of your messages on its servers and maybe even logs your whole activity. Which means it is stored somewhere on a computer. And if the data is stored somewhere it can be hacked. Switch over to some other application if you want more security and privacy otherwise WhatsApp does just fine.
- Download and use Pidgin: The application supports a number of existing messaging protocol, letting you use your existing accounts with it easily. Though the main feature is the end to end encryption which is activated only after the Off-the-Record plugin is added.
- Chatsecure is another free application for both iOS and Android that helps you keep your messages private. It does this by using various open source cryptographic libraries along with OTR and Tor.